



Kinfield Navigator

Family Action Plan for Jan McLaren

Prepared for Paul McLaren, Son or daughter

Date	23 September 2026
Plan version	Version 1.0
Plan reference	AP-06HOEZ

This plan contains personal information. Please share it only with people involved in Jan's care.

Things you told us may need urgent attention

- Recent or repeated falls

You told us something may possibly need urgent attention. Please raise these with their GP or the hospital team first, and with the needs assessment service if one is involved. If someone is in immediate danger or needs urgent medical attention, call 111.

These are listed separately from the planning steps in the rest of this plan.

Your plan at a glance

KEY PRIORITIES

- Now** Reduce the risk of another fall
- Now** Get a needs assessment
- Now** Arrange regular breaks for the carer
- Now** Support dad as the main carer
- Soon** Make the home safer

WHAT NEEDS ATTENTION

- Reduce the risk of another fall
- Get a needs assessment
- Arrange regular breaks for the carer
- Support dad as the main carer

22 actions in this plan, 9 to start now.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Book a GP falls review (within 2 weeks)

Your top priorities

- 1 Reduce the risk of another fall** **Now**
Jan has had two falls in the last 12 months.
- 2 Get a needs assessment** **Now**
Jan has not had a needs assessment yet.
- 3 Arrange regular breaks for the carer** **Now**
dad has not yet had a planned break from caring.

4 Support dad as the main carer **Now**

dad (her partner) is the main carer.

5 Make the home safer **Soon**

You mentioned: risk of falling, stairs, home is too large to manage, being alone and home maintenance or gardening.

What you told us

Jan McLaren, 77, lives with their partner in a house in Masterton.

Jan needs help to move around and has had two falls in the past year.

Current support: help from family.

dad (her partner) is the main carer and describes the strain as high.

What matters most: knowing what we should do first, understanding government funding or entitlements and knowing who to contact.

Notes from the family: i'm not sure

Recommended next steps

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Now			
Now	Book a GP falls review Ask for a medication review and checks of eyesight, blood pressure and feet.	Paul McLaren	Within 2 weeks
Now	Start a strength and balance programme Find a local class or ask for a referral to an in-home programme.	Jan with family support	Within a month
Now	Ask for an occupational therapy home assessment An occupational therapist can recommend rails, seating and changes that make moving around safer.	Family with the GP	Within a month
Now	Ask the GP for a NASC referral Request a needs assessment and explain the main concerns in this plan.	Paul McLaren	This week
Now	Prepare for the assessment Write down the hardest parts of each day, recent events and what the family can and cannot do.	Family	Before the assessment

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Now	Ask about the Carer Support Subsidy Raise it at the needs assessment or call the NASC service directly.	dad	Within 2 weeks
Now	Book a first short break Start with a few hours or a day programme so everyone gets used to it.	Family	Within a month
Now	Book a health check for dad Mention the caring role, sleep and stress so the GP can help.	dad	Within a month
Now	Share caring tasks across the family Agree who covers appointments, shopping, paperwork and regular visits.	Family	Within 2 weeks
Soon			
Soon	Walk through the home for hazards Check lighting, loose mats, clutter on floors, and how easy it is to get in and out of the shower and bed.	Family	Within a month
Soon	List the daily tasks that need help Note what is hard each day (showering, meals, shopping, medicines) so support can be matched to real needs.	Paul McLaren	This week
Soon	Compare private home support while waiting If funded help will take time, a few privately paid hours can bridge the gap.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Check current entitlements Ask Work and Income which allowances apply, such as help with extra costs from a health condition.	Paul McLaren	Within a month
Soon	Find existing legal documents Check with the family lawyer or trustee company whether an EPOA or will already exists, and keep copies.	Paul McLaren	Within 2 weeks
Soon	Fit bathroom rails and a shower seat The bathroom is the most common place for falls at home.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Add rails on both sides of stairs Make sure stairs are well lit, with rails that can be gripped firmly.	Family	Within a month
Soon	Make a one-page emergency sheet List medicines, conditions, allergies and contacts, and keep it on the fridge.	Family	Within 2 weeks

PRIORITY	ACTION	WHO	WHEN
Soon	Agree a backup plan if the main carer is unwell Decide who steps in, and how respite could be arranged at short notice.	Family	Within a month
Plan ahead			
Plan ahead	Start an advance care plan Talk with Jan and the GP about what matters most, and write it down.	Jan with the GP	Within 3 months
Plan ahead	Write a simple money snapshot List income, savings, regular costs and the value of the home, so options can be compared.	Family or EPOA attorney	Within a month
Plan ahead	Have a family conversation about the future Talk about where Jan would like to live and what matters most.	Jan with family	Within 3 months
Plan ahead	Review this plan in six months Update the plan if anything changes sooner.	Family with Kinfield	In 6 months

Your action plan, by topic

Only the topics that apply to Jan are included.

Falls and mobility

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Jan has had two falls in the last 12 months.
- Jan is worried about falling, which can lead to moving less and becoming weaker.

WHY THIS MATTERS

One fall makes another more likely. Many falls can be prevented with a medication review, strength and balance exercise, and a safer home.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Book a GP falls review** · Within 2 weeks · Paul McLaren
Ask for a medication review and checks of eyesight, blood pressure and feet.
- ☐ **Start a strength and balance programme** · Within a month · Jan with family support
Find a local class or ask for a referral to an in-home programme.
- ☐ **Ask for an occupational therapy home assessment** · Within a month · Family with the GP
An occupational therapist can recommend rails, seating and changes that make moving around safer.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

GP · Physiotherapist · Occupational therapist · Live Stronger for Longer classes

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Could any of Jan's medicines be adding to dizziness or falls?
- Should eyesight, blood pressure or bone health be checked after these falls?

Physiotherapist

- Which strength and balance programme suits Jan now?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Strength and balance [7]

Live Stronger for Longer lists community strength and balance classes around New Zealand, and GPs can refer people to an in-home programme.

Needs assessment

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Jan has not had a needs assessment yet.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most funded support for older people in New Zealand, including home support, carer relief and residential care subsidies, starts with a needs assessment by the local NASC service.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Ask the GP for a NASC referral** · This week · Paul McLaren

Request a needs assessment and explain the main concerns in this plan.

- ☐ **Prepare for the assessment** · Before the assessment · Family

Write down the hardest parts of each day, recent events and what the family can and cannot do.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

GP · NASC service · Hospital social worker

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Can you refer Jan for a needs assessment, and how urgent should we say it is?

NASC

- Can family be present at the assessment, and what should we bring?

USEFUL INFORMATION

How assessments work ^[1]

A NASC assessor visits to understand daily needs, health and support, then coordinates the services the person is eligible for.

Respite

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- dad has not yet had a planned break from caring.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Regular breaks protect the carer's own health, and that is often what keeps care at home sustainable.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Ask about the Carer Support Subsidy** · Within 2 weeks · dad

Raise it at the needs assessment or call the NASC service directly.

- ☐ **Book a first short break** · Within a month · Family

Start with a few hours or a day programme so everyone gets used to it.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

NASC · Day programmes · Residential respite providers

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

NASC

- Is dad eligible for the Carer Support Subsidy, and how can it be used?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Carer Support Subsidy [2]

Reimburses part of the cost of a break for full-time unpaid carers. It is allocated through a NASC needs assessment and can pay for a relief carer, a day programme or short residential respite.

Planning breaks [3]

The Ministry of Social Development's guide for carers explains respite options and how to plan them.

Support for the family carer

Now

WHAT WE NOTICED

- dad (her partner) is the main carer.
- dad is under a lot of strain and may be close to exhaustion.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Family carers often put their own health last. If the main carer becomes unwell, the whole care arrangement can fall apart quickly.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Book a health check for dad** · Within a month · dad

Mention the caring role, sleep and stress so the GP can help.

- ☐ **Share caring tasks across the family** · Within 2 weeks · Family

Agree who covers appointments, shopping, paperwork and regular visits.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Carer's own GP · Carers NZ · Wider family and friends

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Can dad have a health check that takes the caring role into account?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Carers NZ [8]

Carers NZ provides information, advice and peer support for family carers.

Staying safely at home

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- You mentioned: risk of falling, stairs, home is too large to manage, being alone and home maintenance or gardening.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Small changes at home, such as working alarms, good lighting and a way to call for help, prevent many emergencies and make it more likely someone can keep living at home.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Walk through the home for hazards** · Within a month · Family

Check lighting, loose mats, clutter on floors, and how easy it is to get in and out of the shower and bed.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family and neighbours · GP or practice nurse · Occupational therapist · Fire and Emergency New Zealand

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

GP

- Would Jan qualify for a funded personal alarm, and how do we arrange it?

Occupational therapist

- Which changes in the home would make the biggest difference to safety?

Home care and support

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Jan currently has help from family.
- Jan needs help with moving around, which makes personal care and daily tasks harder.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The right mix of help, from a few hours of household support to daily personal care, is often what makes staying at home possible and safe.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

☐ **List the daily tasks that need help** · This week · Paul McLaren

Note what is hard each day (showering, meals, shopping, medicines) so support can be matched to real needs.

☐ **Compare private home support while waiting** · Within a month · Family

If funded help will take time, a few privately paid hours can bridge the gap.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Needs Assessment and Service Coordination (NASC) · GP · Home support providers · Pharmacist

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

NASC

- What funded home support could Jan be eligible for, and how long is the wait?

Pharmacist

- Could medicines be supplied in blister packs, and can the pharmacy review them?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Funded support starts with an assessment [1]

Health New Zealand funds home support for eligible older people after a needs assessment by the local NASC service. A GP can make the referral.

Government funding

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- The family has some concerns about the cost of care.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Several government subsidies depend on assessments and applications that take time. Starting early avoids paying costs that could have been covered.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

☐ **Check current entitlements** · Within a month · Paul McLaren

Ask Work and Income which allowances apply, such as help with extra costs from a health condition.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Work and Income · NASC · Budgeting services · Lawyer or financial adviser

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Work and Income

- Which subsidies or allowances could Jan be eligible for now?

NASC

- Does Jan's assessed level of care allow a subsidy application?

EPOA and legal planning

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- An Enduring Power of Attorney for property is not confirmed.
- An Enduring Power of Attorney for personal care and welfare is not confirmed.
- There is no advance care plan recording Jan's wishes.

WHY THIS MATTERS

An EPOA can only be made while a person can still understand it. Without one, the family may need to apply to the Family Court to make decisions, which takes time and money.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Find existing legal documents** · Within 2 weeks · Paul McLaren
Check with the family lawyer or trustee company whether an EPOA or will already exists, and keep copies.
- ☐ **Start an advance care plan** · Within 3 months · Jan with the GP
Talk with Jan and the GP about what matters most, and write it down.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Lawyer or trustee company · GP (for capacity questions) · Te Tari Kaumātua Office for Seniors

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Lawyer

- What does Jan need to set up both EPOAs, and how long will it take?

GP

- Is Jan able to make and sign an EPOA now?

USEFUL INFORMATION

Two kinds of EPOA [5]

One covers property and money, the other covers personal care and welfare. A welfare EPOA only comes into effect if the person is assessed as no longer able to make decisions.

Making an EPOA [4]

Te Tari Kaumātua publishes the standard forms and explains how they must be witnessed.

Advance care planning [6]

An advance care plan records what matters most to a person about future care, so family and clinicians can follow their wishes.

Equipment and home changes

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- The home has stairs Jan needs to use.
- Moving around the home safely needs some support.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Rails, shower seats and the right mobility aids are low-cost changes that prevent falls and keep people independent for longer.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Fit bathroom rails and a shower seat** · Within a month · Family
The bathroom is the most common place for falls at home.
- ☐ **Add rails on both sides of stairs** · Within a month · Family
Make sure stairs are well lit, with rails that can be gripped firmly.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Occupational therapist · Equipment suppliers · Builder for rails and ramps

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Occupational therapist

- Which equipment is funded, and which would we need to buy?

Emergency planning

Soon

WHAT WE NOTICED

- If dad became unwell suddenly, there is no backup plan for Jan's care.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A one-page emergency sheet and a backup carer plan save precious time when something unexpected happens.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Make a one-page emergency sheet** · Within 2 weeks · Family
List medicines, conditions, allergies and contacts, and keep it on the fridge.
- ☐ **Agree a backup plan if the main carer is unwell** · Within a month · Family
Decide who steps in, and how respite could be arranged at short notice.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family · GP · Pharmacist

USEFUL INFORMATION

Emergency kits [9]

Get Ready explains how to prepare a household emergency plan, including medicines and mobility needs.

Financial considerations

[Plan ahead](#)

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Jan owns their home, which affects subsidies and how a move could be funded.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Retirement villages and residential care have very different costs and contracts. Understanding them early avoids rushed decisions.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Write a simple money snapshot** · Within a month · Family or EPOA attorney

List income, savings, regular costs and the value of the home, so options can be compared.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Financial adviser · Lawyer · Free budgeting services

QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING

Financial adviser

- How would each option affect Jan's income and assets over five years?

Future planning

[Plan ahead](#)

WHAT WE NOTICED

- Jan's goals: knowing what we should do first, understanding government funding or entitlements and knowing who to contact.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Talking about wishes before a crisis means future decisions reflect what Jan wants.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

- ☐ **Have a family conversation about the future** · Within 3 months · Jan with family

Talk about where Jan would like to live and what matters most.

- ☐ **Review this plan in six months** · In 6 months · Family with Kinfield

Update the plan if anything changes sooner.

WHO MAY BE ABLE TO HELP

Family · GP · Kinfield navigator

Action checklist

Tick actions off as they are done. Your navigator can update the plan with your progress.

Now

- ☐ Book a GP falls review · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Start a strength and balance programme · Within a month
- ☐ Ask for an occupational therapy home assessment · Within a month
- ☐ Ask the GP for a NASC referral · This week
- ☐ Prepare for the assessment · Before the assessment
- ☐ Ask about the Carer Support Subsidy · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Book a first short break · Within a month
- ☐ Book a health check for dad · Within a month
- ☐ Share caring tasks across the family · Within 2 weeks

Soon

- ☐ Walk through the home for hazards · Within a month
- ☐ List the daily tasks that need help · This week
- ☐ Compare private home support while waiting · Within a month
- ☐ Check current entitlements · Within a month
- ☐ Find existing legal documents · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Fit bathroom rails and a shower seat · Within a month
- ☐ Add rails on both sides of stairs · Within a month
- ☐ Make a one-page emergency sheet · Within 2 weeks
- ☐ Agree a backup plan if the main carer is unwell · Within a month

Plan ahead

- ☐ Start an advance care plan · Within 3 months
- ☐ Write a simple money snapshot · Within a month
- ☐ Have a family conversation about the future · Within 3 months
- ☐ Review this plan in six months · In 6 months

We can help you carry this out

Kinfield Navigator can help your family work through this plan: making calls, preparing for assessments and appointments, comparing options and updating the plan as things change.

Phone 0123456789 · **Email** plans@kinfield.example

Sources and important information

1. Ageing support, Healthify. <https://healthify.nz/support/a/ageing-support> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
2. Carer Support Subsidy, Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora. <https://www.healthnz.govt.nz/hospitals-services/eligibility-subsidies/carers-support-subsidy> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
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6. Advance care planning, Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora. <https://www.myacp.org.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
7. Live Stronger for Longer, ACC and partners. <https://www.livestronger.org.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
8. Carers NZ, Carers New Zealand. <https://carers.net.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)
9. Get Ready: emergency preparedness, National Emergency Management Agency. <https://getready.govt.nz/> (reviewed 22 September 2026)

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This plan gives general information based on what your family told us. It is not medical, legal or financial advice. Eligibility for funding and services is decided by the agencies involved, and details such as thresholds change over time. Please check with the relevant professional before making decisions.